

Rep. Tom Emmer on Washington Watch

NRBTV

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HOST (JODY):

I want to shift gears now and jump over to Capitol Hill and get an update on the funding battle. From a congressional point of view and joining me now to discuss this and more is the House Majority Whip, Tom Emmer. Among other things, he serves on the House Financial Services Committee and he represents the 6th Congressional District of Minnesota. He and I actually came into Congress in the same class and it was a great honor to be able to serve with Tom Emmer. Whip Emmer, welcome back to Washington Watch. Great to see you, my friend.

REP. TOM EMMER:

It's good to see you making good since you got out of this place, Jody. You're looking good.

HOST (JODY):

Well, you are too, as always. Listen, you and I both know how difficult these reconciliation bills can be, but what the parliamentarian did from the Senate is kind of a shake-up. It's crunch time now. What's the GOP plan? Where do you go from here?

REP. TOM EMMER:

Well, this is all Senate, right? The House is constantly doing our job and the Senate has all these snags. At this point, the CBP and the ICE funding, even those had some technical issues that have to be cleaned up. When you go through this Byrd process, which is a Senate process only, it's got to be revenue and expense and there are specific rules that the parliamentarian applies with precedent from past decisions and things like that. In this case, they have a bunch of technical changes that they have to do. And then, of course, the ballroom totally was excluded. John Thune has made the statement that they can fix it. He believes that they can fix the language and get it submitted in time to get this thing moving on the voterama and hopefully have it to the House, I would hope, before Friday morning, at the latest Friday morning.

HOST (JODY):

Yeah, I remember the — and you may recall this, but I actually had a repeal of the Johnson Amendment that passed the House. In fact, we passed it in the House twice. Both times failed in the Senate. But once in the Senate, the parliamentarian just didn't like it and threw it out. So it's amazing the power that the parliamentarian carries over, particularly in the Senate, it seems. So what does all this mean? What does this mean for the deadline, for example? I mean, we've got coming up. Is there enough time to get this passed, do you think?

REP. TOM EMMER:

Absolutely. They just got to get it out of the Senate. Jody, let's keep in mind with the parliamentarian. Everybody wants to complain about the parliamentarian. Look, if those in charge of the Senate don't like the

parliamentarian's decision, Jody, they can override the parliamentarian. It's been done in the past. It can be done right. But they use this. The Senate uses this as a tool when there's, I think, internal division about this sort of thing. So we'll see. And the ballroom, I mean, it's so disingenuous. And for those of you that are listening to this, it's dishonest. Another word for dishonest by the leader over there, Chuck Schumer, to be talking about inflation has never been higher. What are you talking about? Joe Biden ran this darn economy into the ditch. Donald Trump and Republicans have been pulling it out for the better part of a year and a half. And he talks about everything. Gas is the one that is killing us right now. And that's because of the Iran conflict. It will straighten out as soon as that straightens out. In the meantime, there's lots of good news in our economy, Jody. They don't want to talk about it. They don't want to talk about the fact that grocery prices overall, with the exception of beef, are down. They don't want to talk about the fact that rents are down, that mortgage payments are at a five-year low. There's all kinds of good news that are in the economy. And that's not even about the billions of dollars that are being reinvested into our country for new manufacturing, artificial intelligence projects. All of these things are happening right now. And it's going to benefit Americans for years to come. But no, Chuck Schumer's got to get up on the House floor and do what he does better than anybody else, which is lie like he lies.

HOST (JODY):

Wow. Well, I know you brought up a number of initiatives right there. I know there's a lot that the Republicans want to try to deal with before the Memorial Day weekend. What are some of the key issues coming up this week?

REP. TOM EMMER:

Well, we're supposed to do the SCORE Act. That's the ground rules for NIL, the college sports experience that we've had. The schools want a solution to stop the runaway transfers, all the different things that are happening in college sports. That's supposed to be up on Wednesday. I think that is still the plan. We got a bunch of primaries, though, tomorrow across the country, places like Utah, your home state of Georgia, Kentucky. Those are going to impact, I would think, what's going to be happening. Plus, the Senate is going to impact on what we do here in the House. I'll give you an example. If the Votorama can start, well, there'll be a vote on Wednesday to go to the Votorama. If that passes, well, then you'll get to the Votorama. We'll see. If people want to get out of here before the Memorial weekend, the Senate could fast track that, Jody. If that happens, I would bet that our great leader, Steve Scalise from Louisiana, is not going to keep everyone here for the rest of the week. I think the number one thing is to make sure that our Customs and Border Patrol and our great Immigration and Customs Enforcement agencies are fully funded. That is the mission this week. There will be other things, obviously, but that's the main mission.

HOST (JODY):

Well, hats off to you. I know you got your plate full, and you guys are doing an amazing job keeping the call straight. Before I let you go, we've only got about a minute or so left, but I wanted to get your take on the fraud scandal in your own state. There's reports, at least, that Ilhan Omar knew about the 250 million COVID meal scandal, the fraud. What's your take on how investigations are going in Minnesota?

REP. TOM EMMER:

I think investigations are well underway, and I think Ilhan Omar was well aware of the corruption that was going on. She was right in the middle of it. I think we've got to find out not only if she knew, but did she benefit off it? If she did, I mean, she should literally be sent back to Somalia. At the very least, she should go to prison. I think Keith Ellison, our Attorney General, who you and I served with for a couple of years here in Washington, I think

Ellison was well aware. Keith Ellison is trying to make it sound like-

HOST (JODY):

We've got to wrap up. Listen, there's a lot going on with the fraud, a lot more to come, Jody. House Majority Whip, Tom Emmer. Great to see you. Thank you for coming on Washington Watch and I hope to see you soon.

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